

NovaCart Employee Handbook 2026 - Section 1: Working at NovaCart

NovaCart is a fictional e-commerce company headquartered in Bengaluru with offices in Pune and Hyderabad.

This handbook applies to all full-time employees from 1 January 2026.

Standard working hours are 9:30 AM to 6:30 PM, Monday to Friday, including a one-hour lunch break. Core collaboration hours, when every employee must be reachable, are 11:00 AM to 4:00 PM IST.

New employees complete a 6-month probation period. During probation the notice period is 15 days; after confirmation the notice period is 60 days.

Every new joiner is assigned an onboarding buddy for the first 30 days. The buddy helps with tools, team introductions and the first production deployment.

Section 2: Leave Policy

Every confirmed employee receives 24 days of paid annual leave per calendar year. Annual leave is credited monthly at the rate of 2 days per month.

Employees receive 12 days of sick leave per year. Sick leave longer than 3 consecutive days requires a medical certificate uploaded to the HR portal.

Unused annual leave can be carried forward to the next year, up to a maximum of 8 days. Any balance above 8 days lapses on 31 December and is not encashed.

Parental leave: primary caregivers receive 26 weeks of paid leave; secondary caregivers receive 4 weeks of paid leave, which must be taken within 6 months of the child's arrival.

NovaCart observes 10 fixed public holidays and 2 floating holidays that employees choose themselves.

Section 3: Hybrid and Remote Work

NovaCart follows a hybrid model: employees work from the office 3 days per week. Tuesday and Thursday are mandatory office days for all teams; the third day is chosen by the team.

Employees may work fully remotely for up to 4 weeks per year, with manager approval requested at least 2 weeks in advance.

Home-office equipment allowance: every employee may claim up to Rs 25,000 once every 3 years for a chair, desk, monitor or headset. Claims are submitted through the expense portal with receipts.

Company laptops are refreshed every 4 years. Working from a public network is allowed only when the NovaCart VPN is connected.

Section 4: Expenses and Code of Conduct

Business expenses must be submitted within 30 days of the expense date. Claims older than 30 days are rejected automatically by the expense portal.

Daily meal allowance during business travel is Rs 1,500 in metro cities and Rs 1,000 elsewhere. Domestic flights must be booked in economy class at least 7 days before travel.

Employees must not accept gifts from vendors worth more than Rs 2,000. Any gift above this limit must be reported to the ethics team at ethics@novacart.example.

Conflicts of interest, such as holding a stake in a supplier, must be declared within 15 days of joining or of the conflict arising.